

WILL MCGOWAN

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EDUCATION

University of Strathclyde, Glasgow

Sep 2023 – Jun 2027 (expected)

BA (Hons) Economics

- Average grade to date: 2:1, including 90% in first-year Finance
- Second-highest mark (78%) in a group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets
- **Relevant Modules:** Treasury Management and Derivatives, Industrial Economics, Applied Econometrics

Dissertation | MATLAB

In progress, due 2027

"Who Hedges the Barrel? Sovereign Oil Hedging and Petro-Currency Reactions to OPEC News"

- Testing whether governments that hedge oil blunt their currencies' reaction to OPEC news: Norway's krone conversions (vs unhedged Canada), Russia's 2017–22 budget rule and Mexico's put hedge
- Breaking the question into one testable prediction per country and building an original dataset from Norges Bank and Russian and Mexican finance ministry records to test each

FX Risk Management | group project

Treasury Management and Derivatives

- Mapped six multinationals' currency exposure through revenues and costs, then compared how each manages it, from Toyota and Nestlé to NVIDIA and Reliance Industries

Empirical CAPM Test

MATLAB

- Tested whether the CAPM explains returns on 694 anomaly portfolios across 54 countries, then corrected for running so many tests: 123 of 215 apparent anomalies survive, led by momentum and value

Monte Carlo Option Pricing Engine

MATLAB

- Priced European and Asian options by simulation, benchmarked against Black-Scholes; a geometric-Asian control variate cut the arithmetic-Asian standard error by 97%, equivalent to 1,276 times as many paths

Belfast Royal Academy, Belfast

Jun 2023

- A-levels: Mathematics (A), Economics (A), Computer Science (B)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Le Set, Glasgow | Head Mixologist

Sep 2026 – Present

- Designed the 11-drink menu for a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge, including 4 original cocktails
- Wrote batch specifications for 5 pre-batched cocktails and trained around 15 staff to serve them consistently

KONG, Glasgow | Mixologist and Front of House

Oct 2024 – Jun 2026

- Analysed sales patterns to refine upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%
- Trained new staff on drink specifications, POS and licensing rules; reconciled cash and card takings each shift

LEADERSHIP AND ACTIVITIES

Strathclyde Agricapital Society | Co-Founder and Treasurer

Sep 2025 – Present

- Co-founded Strathclyde's first agri-finance society, grew it to 126 members and wrote weekly research notes
- Led weekly sessions taking apart agribusiness deals such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC: why this buyer, why now, how it was structured and at what price
- As Treasurer, manage the society's budget and accounts

Strathclyde Poker Society | Vice-President, then President

Sep 2025 – Apr 2026

- Ran weekly tournaments for about 60 players on a £600 budget per semester, reconciling buy-ins and prizes
- Taught new members to use the Kelly criterion to estimate how many buy-ins their win rate, variance and risk level call for, with a buffer in case the edge is overestimated

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Technical: Excel, R, MATLAB, Git

Chess: 14th at the 2023 Irish U19 Championships; played 22 opponents at once (average 1860 FIDE) and won 21

Powerlifting: Northern Ireland U19 champion (2023)